

United States — Coast Guard Role Requirements

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ROLE	CATEGORY	EDUCATION	APTITUDE	FITNESS	MEDICAL	NOTES
Boatswain's Mate (BM)	Maritime Operations	High school diploma	ASVAB VE+MK score; no fixed minimum but applies to all rates	Standard to High — swimming required	Medical suitability required	Deck seamanship, boat operations, search and rescue; physically active; wide range of platforms from boats to large cutters
Maritime Enforcement Specialist (ME)	Security / Law Enforcement	High school diploma	ASVAB AR+VE score	Standard to High	Medical suitability required	Maritime law enforcement, counter-narcotics, port security; background investigation required; law enforcement authority at sea
Machinery Technician (MK)	Technical	High school diploma; mechanical aptitude helpful	ASVAB AR+MK mechanical score	Standard	Medical suitability required	Engine and machinery maintenance afloat and ashore; civilian mechanical qualifications recognised; strong trade pathway
Operations Specialist (OS)	Maritime Operations	High school diploma	ASVAB VE+AR score	Standard	Medical suitability required	Search and rescue coordination, command centre operations, radar, and communications; afloat and ashore billets
Health Services Technician (HS)	Medical	High school diploma; science courses helpful	ASVAB VE+MK or science composite	Standard	Medical suitability required	Medical and dental support; comparable to Navy Hospital Corpsman; afloat and shore billets; civilian healthcare skills valued
Information Systems Technician (IT)	Cyber / IT	High school diploma; IT background helpful	ASVAB Electronics (E) score	Standard	Medical suitability required	IT networks and communications systems; security clearance required; supports command, control, and communications
Aviation Maintenance Technician (AMT)	Aviation	High school diploma; technical subjects helpful	ASVAB MM or EL score	Standard	Medical suitability required	Aircraft maintenance for CG aviation fleet (HC-144, HC-130, MH-65, MH-60); FAA A&P licence pathway possible
Rescue Swimmer (AST pathway)	Special / Rescue	High school diploma	ASVAB VE+MK applies; demanding physical screening	Very High — AST swim and physical standards	Enhanced medical including swim fitness assessment	Aviation Survival Technician; helicopter rescue swimmer in open water; one of the most demanding CG rate selections

